

Chapter 3, Section 5

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1. Let X be a projective scheme over a field k , and let $\mathcal{F}$ be a coherent sheaf on X . We define the *Euler characteristic* of $\mathcal{F}$ by

$$\chi(\mathcal{F}) = \sum (-1)^i \dim_k H^i(X, \mathcal{F}).$$

If

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}'' \longrightarrow 0$$

is a short exact sequence of coherent sheaves on X , show that $\chi(\mathcal{F}) = \chi(\mathcal{F}') + \chi(\mathcal{F}'')$.

Proof. We get an exact sequence of finite dimensional k -vector spaces (5.2)

$$\dots \xrightarrow{\delta_{i-1}} H^i(X, \mathcal{F}') \longrightarrow H^i(X, \mathcal{F}) \longrightarrow H^i(X, \mathcal{F}'') \xrightarrow{\delta_i} \dots,$$

where the δ_i 's are connecting homomorphisms. By exactness, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \chi(\mathcal{F}) &= \sum (-1)^i \dim_k H^i(X, \mathcal{F}) \\ &= \sum (-1)^i (\dim_k \operatorname{coker} \delta_{i-1} + \dim_k \ker \delta_i) \\ &= \sum (-1)^i (\dim_k H^i(X, \mathcal{F}') - \dim_k \operatorname{im} \delta_{i-1} + \dim_k H^i(X, \mathcal{F}'') - \dim_k \operatorname{im} \delta_i) \\ &= \sum (-1)^i \dim_k H^i(X, \mathcal{F}') + \sum (-1)^i \dim_k H^i(X, \mathcal{F}'') \\ &= \chi(\mathcal{F}') + \chi(\mathcal{F}''). \end{aligned}$$

□

2. (a) Let X be a projective scheme over a field k , let $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$ be a very ample invertible sheaf on X over k , and let $\mathcal{F}$ be a coherent sheaf on X . Show that there is a polynomial $P(z) \in \mathbb{Q}[z]$, such that $\chi(\mathcal{F}(n)) = P(n)$ for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. We call P the *Hilbert polynomial* of $\mathcal{F}$ with respect to the sheaf $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$.
 (b) Now let $X = \mathbb{P}_k^r$, and let $M = \Gamma_*(\mathcal{F})$, considered as a graded $S = k[x_0, \dots, x_r]$ -module. Use (5.2) to show that the Hilbert polynomial of $\mathcal{F}$ just defined is the same as the Hilbert polynomial of M defined in (I, §7).

Proof.

- (a) Since $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$ is a very ample sheaf on X over k , there is a closed immersion $i : X \rightarrow \mathbb{P}_k^r$ of schemes over k , for some r , such that $\mathcal{O}_X(1) = i^* \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^r}(1)$. If $\mathcal{F}$ is coherent on X , then $i_* \mathcal{F}$ is coherent on $\mathbb{P}_k^r$ (II, Ex. 5.5), and the cohomology is the same (2.10). The Euler characteristic is defined in terms of cohomology, so we reduce to the case $X = \mathbb{P}_k^r$.

Cover X by a finite number of open affines $U_i \cong \operatorname{Spec} k[y_1, \dots, y_r]$. Then there exist finitely generated $k[y_1, \dots, y_r]$ -modules M_i such that $\mathcal{F}|_{U_i} \cong \tilde{M}_i$. Since $\operatorname{Spec} A_i \cap \operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}$ is a closed subset of $\operatorname{Spec} A_i$; in fact, $\operatorname{Spec} A_i \cap \operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F} = V(\operatorname{Ann} M_i)$ (AM, Ex. 3.19), $\operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}$ is a closed subset of X . We proceed by induction on $\dim \operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}$. If $\operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}$ has dimension zero, then $\operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F} \cap U_i$ is affine (II, Ex. 3.11b) equal to spectra of a Noetherian ring A of dimension zero, which are precisely Artinian rings (AM, 8.5). So $U_i \cap \operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}$ is a finite set (AM, Ex. 8.2), and since X can be covered by a finite number of U_i , $\operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}$ is a finite set of closed points. Thus, $\mathcal{F}$ is isomorphic to a direct sum of skyscraper sheaves. More precisely, $\mathcal{F} = \bigoplus_{P \in \operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}} \mathcal{F}_P$, where $\mathcal{F}_P$ is the stalk of $\mathcal{F}$ at P , and cohomology commutes with direct sums, so by (Ex. 1), we reduce to the case when $\operatorname{Supp} \mathcal{F}$ consists of a single point. Then, $\chi(\mathcal{F}(n))$ is just the Hilbert polynomial of $\mathcal{F}_P$ (I, 7.5) as a graded $A[y_1, \dots, y_r]$ -module.

Assume the statement to be true for all coherent sheaves with suPort dimension less than n . Consider the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_X(-1) \xrightarrow{x_r} \mathcal{O}_X \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_H \longrightarrow 0,$$

where H is the hyperplane $x_r = 0$. Taking the tensor product of this sequence with $\mathcal{F}$ gives us

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{R} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}(-1) \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}_H \longrightarrow 0,$$

where $\mathcal{R}$ is the kernel of the map $\mathcal{F}(-1) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$. Twisting by $\mathcal{O}_X(n)$ is exact, so we get

$$\chi(\mathcal{F}(n)) - \chi(\mathcal{F}(n-1)) = \chi(\mathcal{F}_H(n)) - \chi(\mathcal{R}(n))$$

by (III, Ex. 5.1). Consider the coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module $\mathcal{R}$. It vanishes under the multiplication map x_r , where x_r locally defines one of the coordinates such that $x_r = 0$ is the defining equation for H , and such that there is a inclusion $\text{Supp } \mathcal{R} \subseteq H$, which exists by Bertini's theorem. Since $H \cong \mathbb{P}_k^{r-1}$, we can apply the induction hypothesis to $\mathcal{R}$ and $\mathcal{F}_H$, so let $P_{\mathcal{R}}(z), P_{\mathcal{F}_H}(z) \in \mathbb{Q}[z]$ be polynomials such that

$$\chi(\mathcal{R}(n)) = P_{\mathcal{R}}(n), \quad \chi(\mathcal{F}_H(n)) = P_{\mathcal{F}_H}(n).$$

The difference function of $\chi(\mathcal{F}(n))$ is equal to $P_{\mathcal{F}_H}(n) - P_{\mathcal{R}}(n) \in \mathbb{Q}[z]$, so by (§1, 7.3), we conclude that $\chi(\mathcal{F}(n)) = P(n)$ for some $P(z) \in \mathbb{Q}[z]$.

- (b) By (5.2), there exists an integer n_0 such that for each $i > 0$ and each $n \geq n_0$, $H^i(X, \mathcal{F}(n)) = 0$. Let $P(n)$ be the Hilbert polynomial just defined, and let $P'(n)$ be the polynomial from associated to the graded S -module M from (I, §7). Then $P(n) = \dim_k H^0(X, \mathcal{F}(n))$ for each $n \geq n_0$, but $M_n = \Gamma(X, \mathcal{F}(n)) = H^0(X, \mathcal{F}(n))$ and $P'(n) = \dim_k M_n$; in particular, $P(n)$ and $P'(n)$ agree at infinitely many values. Hence, they must be equal.

□

3. *Arithmetic Genus.* Let X be a projective scheme of dimension r over a field k . We define the *arithmetic genus* p_a of X by

$$p_a(X) = (-1)^r (\chi(\mathcal{O}_X) - 1).$$

Note that it depends only on X , not on any projective embedding.

- (a) If X is integral, and k algebraically closed, show that $H^0(X, \mathcal{O}_X) \cong k$, so that

$$p_a(X) = \sum_{i=0}^{r-1} (-1)^i \dim_k H^{r-i}(X, \mathcal{O}_X).$$

In particular, if X is a curve, we have

$$p_a(X) = \dim_k H^1(X, \mathcal{O}_X).$$

- (b) If X is a closed subvariety of $\mathbb{P}_k^r$, show that this $p_a(X)$ coincides with the one defined in (I, Ex. 7.2), which apparently depended on the projective embedding.
- (c) If X is a nonsingular projective curve over an algebraically closed field k , show that $p_a(X)$ is in fact a *birational* invariant. Conclude that a nonsingular plane curve of degree $d \geq 3$ is not rational.

Proof.

- (a) By (II, Ex. 2.4), there exists a natural bijection

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{Sch}(k)}(X, \mathbb{A}^1) \cong \text{Hom}_{\text{Alg}(k)}(k[t], \Gamma(X, \mathcal{O}_X)).$$

The space on the right is naturally isomorphic to $H^0(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ as vector spaces over k , so it is enough to show any morphism $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{A}^1$ over k must be constant. Since X is projective over k , and $\mathbb{A}^1$ is separated scheme over k , by (II, Ex. 4.8) f is a proper morphism. In particular, f is a closed map, so the image of X in $\mathbb{A}^1$ is a closed subscheme. The proper closed subschemes of $\mathbb{A}^1$ are finite sets of points. But the image of a proper scheme is proper (II, Ex. 4.4), and $\mathbb{A}^1$ is not a proper scheme over k . Hence, f must be constant.

- (b) Let $\mathcal{I}_X$ be the ideal sheaf of X on $\mathbb{P}_k^r$. The homogenous coordinate ring $S(X)$ of X for the given embedding is $k[x_0, \dots, x_r]/I$, where I is the ideal $\Gamma_*(\mathcal{I}_X)$ (II, Ex. 5.14). The result follows by (Ex. 1) and (Ex. 2b).

